



FIGURE 11.12 A Bahraini bride in traditional green *thobe*. She wears a circular gold plate (*hama* or *taasa*) on her head, with the chains of discs *talaat* suspended from the rim. Sweet basil (*mishmun*), jasmine, and rosebuds adorn her hair. Around her wrists she wears gold bangles, including the *shmelat*, studded with turquoise and pink glass. She wears a *murta'asha* choker and a long *murtahish* necklace ending in a crescent element.

central element. As seen in figure 11.11, a *seytemi* may be added to this; it can be identified by the row of gold coins running up the chain and “it is among the most sought after pieces of jewellery by women in the U.A.E.”⁷² All these pieces may vary in size and weight. At her waist, the bride will wear a

gold belt (*hizam*), which is usually composed of articulated square or round elements with smaller dangling bells or tassels. On her hands, she will often have rings on each finger, especially the *shahida* ring, worn on both forefingers, and the *marami* on the middle finger. The back of her hand may be covered in the *kaf* or *chef* ornament, which runs from rings and is anchored to a bracelet. She also

⁷² Gubash and Lootah, *Traditional Emirati Jewels*, 62.